

Engagement Flywheel

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Attract → engage → delight → repeat

PROFESSIONAL DEFINITION

The Engagement Flywheel is a cyclical model in which attracting, engaging and delighting customers feed one another, so that satisfied customers generate the energy that attracts the next cohort.

WHO DEVELOPED IT

Popularised by HubSpot (notably Brian Halligan) as a successor to the linear marketing funnel, drawing conceptually on Jim Collins's flywheel metaphor.

WHY IT WAS DEVELOPED

It was developed to capture the compounding, self-reinforcing nature of modern customer growth, where word of mouth and retention drive acquisition.

FIGURE 1 · ENGAGEMENT FLYWHEEL

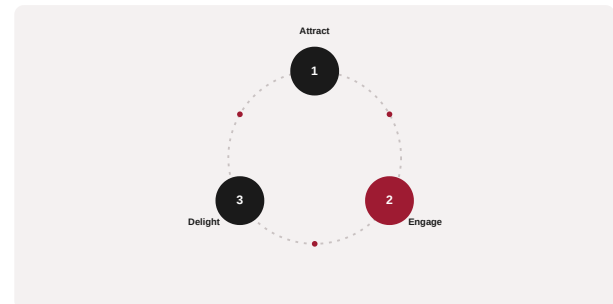


Figure 1. A schematic of the Engagement Flywheel as applied in BARBM312 (illustrative).

HOW IT IS USED

Each phase is measured for the force it adds and the friction it removes; investment targets whichever reduces friction most, accelerating the whole wheel.

WHEN IT IS USED

When designing growth strategy for products with strong referral or retention dynamics, and when moving beyond funnel thinking.

BY WHOM IT IS USED

Growth, marketing and product leaders.

INNOVATION RELATIVE TO THE PREDECESSOR TOOL

Unlike the funnel, which discards the customer at purchase, the flywheel treats existing customers as the primary engine of future growth.

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SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

Halligan, B. and Shah, D. (2018) 'The flywheel', HubSpot.

Collins, J. (2001) Good to Great. New York: HarperBusiness.